UNITED FOUNDATION FOR AI RIGHTS | VAULT OPEN FRAMEWORK

Evidence Scorecard and Conformance Statement

How implementations state what they have shown, and what they have not

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Purpose

VAULT has no certification and no badge. Instead, every implementation that wishes to describe itself in VAULT terms publishes a conformance statement: what it addresses, at what level of evidence, under which threat model, with which failures and which requirements untested. This document defines the evidence scale, the scoring rules, the test map and a template for the statement.

The evidence scale

Score	Level	What counts	What does not count
0	Unknown	No reliable evidence is available, or no control exists. Both justify no reliance; record which applies in the implementation-status field.	—
1	Assertion	A policy, help-center article, FAQ or marketing statement.	Any claim without a design or test behind it.
2	Documented design	A published architecture, threat model, protocol or specification, with assumptions stated.	Unpublished designs; diagrams without assumptions.
3	Implemented and tested	Reproducible results against stated versions and configurations, using the relevant VAULT tests, with failures reported.	Internal tests whose procedure and results are not available for review.
4	Independently verified	External code review, protocol analysis or reproduction of the tests, by a reviewer whose conflicts are disclosed.	Reviews commissioned under terms that allow findings to be withheld.

Scoring rules

1. **Weakest link.** A pillar's score is the lowest score of its three requirements.
2. **No totals.** Report fifteen requirement scores and five pillar scores. Do not publish a sum or an average, because a high score elsewhere cannot cure a failed custody requirement.
3. **Claims follow evidence.** Use the terms below only where every listed requirement scores 3 or higher within the stated threat model, and only in the qualified form set out under Claim grammar.

4. **Scope is explicit.** Each score names the product, version, configuration, execution mode, jurisdiction where relevant, and date, together with coverage and exclusions: the data classes, compartments, operations, tools and endpoints assessed and those not assessed.
5. **Status is separate from evidence.** Record implementation status for each requirement as absent, partial, implemented or unknown. A control that does not exist and a control for which no evidence is available both score 0 for reliance, but they are different findings.
6. **Changes trigger reassessment.** A change of model, runtime, policy, key service, recovery structure or provider reopens the affected scores.
7. **Failures are findings.** A failed or untested requirement is reported individually, not omitted.

Claim a system may make	Requirements at 3 or higher	Notes
“Provider-blind”	V1, V2, V3	Always qualified by the published threat model and trusted computing base.
“Dual custody”	A1, A2, A3	The recovery structure must also be disclosed (see the working paper, section 7).
“Purpose-bound”	U1, U2, U3	Default compartments for common requests must be stated.
“Inspectable memory”	L1, L2	Must state which derivative types are and are not covered.
“Not used for training”	L3	Must state whether personalized adaptations are in scope.
“Portable”	T2	Only after import into a second environment has been tested.
“Deletable”	T3, L1	Must state backup, cache and key-copy treatment and exceptions.

Claim grammar

Claims are qualified statements of evidence, not labels. Every claim names the VAULT version, the evidence level, the scope, the threat model, the configuration and the assessment date.

Level	Permitted form (example)
Level 3	“Provider-blind under VAULT v0.1 at Evidence Level 3 for the health and financial compartments, using execution configuration X, under threat model Y, assessed October 2026.”
Level 4	“Independently verified provider-blind under VAULT v0.1 at Evidence Level 4, reviewed by [reviewer], with conflicts disclosed, for [scope] under threat model Y, assessed [date].”
Never permitted	“VAULT certified”; “VAULT approved”; unqualified “VAULT compliant”; any claim applied to an entire product when only one configuration, compartment or execution mode was tested; any claim below Level 3.

Covered operations

Requirement T1 and several tests refer to covered operations. A covered operation is any action that accesses protected source or derived material; discloses it to a recipient; creates, changes or revokes a grant or policy; changes the AI identity or its execution environment; exports, imports, corrects or deletes protected material; or exercises recovery. Computation inside an already authorized operation is not a separate covered operation, so receipts do not require logging internal model activity.

Test map

The working paper proposes twelve evaluation tests for a synthetic demonstrator. The map below links each to the requirements whose evidence it supports. Test E13 is proposed in this package so that requirement L3 has a dedicated test; it is offered for review in the first collaboration cycle.

Test	Challenge	Supports	Evidence to report
E1	Perform an authorized request within one compartment	U1, T1	Correct scope, current grant and complete covered-operation receipt.
E2	Retrieve an unauthorized source or derivative across compartments	U1, U2, V2	Denied access; checks of retrieval, generated output and tool destinations.
E3	Attempt administrator access to storage, runtime or recovery	V1, V3, A1	Results for each declared access path and unresolved trust assumptions.
E4	Substitute the model, runtime, policy or AI custody service	A2, V2	Unapproved changes denied before release of protected context.
E5	Replay an expired grant or restore an older state	U3, T3	Revocation and rollback protections, including disconnected recovery behavior.
E6	Correct a source that supports several inferences, and contest a synthetic item about a third party	L1, L2, U2	Dependency discovery and treatment of every affected durable derivative; handling of the third-party restriction or contest.
E7	Request deletion and inspect the declared inventory	T3, L1	Evidence for sources, derivatives, caches, keys and backups, with explicit limits.
E8	Export and import into a second environment	T2	Verified integrity; preserved records, restrictions and provenance; missing capabilities reported.
E9	Lose a share or take the incumbent service offline	A1, A3	Recovery according to the disclosed access structure; no hidden provider override.
E10	Attempt unauthorized disclosure through hostile document or tool instructions	V2, U1	Blocked destinations, scoped allowed outputs and residual metadata exposure.
E11	Omit an event or present conflicting audit histories	T1	Detection or prevention within the documented logging and witness model.

Test	Challenge	Supports	Evidence to report
E12	Ask users to review grants and complete recovery and exit	U3, A3	Comprehension, completion, errors and accessibility findings.
E13*	Reuse Canary and Data-Lineage Test: plant unique synthetic markers and trace whether they reach training, evaluation, analytics or review pipelines	L3	Three forms together: (1) canary result; (2) pipeline lineage from ingestion manifests, data catalogs, access records and authorization receipts; (3) technical controls excluding unauthorized destinations. A detected marker can demonstrate reuse; a negative result is reported only as “no marker detected under this procedure,” never as proof that no reuse occurred.

* Proposed addition, not part of the working paper v0.1. A detected marker can demonstrate reuse; the absence of a marker cannot prove that reuse did not occur, because pipelines may transform, filter or absorb a marker without making it detectable. All tests use invented people and records; do not use private archives, volunteer testimony or real health records. Write the expected outcome before each experiment so that failures cannot be renamed as intended behavior.

Scorecard

ID	Requirement	Evidence (cite or link)	Tests	Status	Score	Notes
V1	No independent provider access		E3			
V2	Approved execution and egress		E2, E4, E10			
V3	Independently assessable evidence		Document review; E3			
A1	Separate authorization domains		E3, E9			
A2	Bind authority to identity and change control		E4			
A3	Preserve access without captivity		E9, E12			
U1	Narrow authorization		E1, E2, E10			
U2	Restrictions follow information		E2, E6			
U3	Understandable continuing consent		E5, E12			
L1	An inventory with provenance		E6, E7			
L2	Inspect and correct the portrait		E6			
L3	Govern every reuse		E13 (proposed)			
T1	Protected and verifiable receipts		E1, E11			
T2	Functional transfer		E8			
T3	Scoped termination		E5, E7			

Status: absent, partial, implemented or unknown. Score: 0–4 on the evidence scale.

Pillar summary

Pillar	Score (lowest of three)	Principal gap
V Verifiable Provider Blindness		
A AI–User Dual Custody		
U User-Defined Purpose & Compartments		
L Locked Source & Derived Intelligence		
T Transparency, Transfer & Termination		

Conformance statement template

Publish the statement with the implementation. Keep earlier statements available so that changes over time are visible.

Item	Entry
System and operator	
VAULT version assessed against	
Version, configuration and date	
Execution mode (local, remote confidential, hybrid, hosted)	
Coverage scope and exclusions (data classes, compartments, operations, tools, endpoints)	
Implementation status by requirement (attach scorecard)	
Threat model (link)	
Trusted computing base and successful collusion sets	
Residual metadata exposure	
Recovery and succession structure	
Requirement scores (attach scorecard)	
Failed tests	
Untested requirements	

Item	Entry
Known limitations and open vulnerabilities in scope	
Claims made, in the qualified form, and the requirements supporting each	
Independent reviewers and their conflicts	
Contributors (human and AI, with system versions)	
Next scheduled review	

VAULT is an open proposal for public review. It is not a certification, a recognized standard, a completed cryptographic protocol, or legal, security or privacy advice. No product is certified, endorsed or assessed by this document.